

Philipp Hilbert. *AI Product Owner bridging deep technical fluency with structured delivery.*

Positioning, AI-native Product Owner with ten years of cross-functional delivery experience, ready to drive ML and GenAI projects end-to-end at ZEISS.

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Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Product Owner – Artificial Intelligence role at ZEISS. The position sits at the intersection I have spent the last several years building toward: technically demanding AI and data projects, cross-functional stakeholder environments, and the delivery discipline needed to move from scope definition to production rollout without losing either the engineering team or the business stakeholders along the way.

At Rohde & Schwarz, I owned the full product lifecycle of a central AI and data management platform built for the European defence programme FCAS. The platform handled multimodal datasets across image, audio, and tabular sources, with requirements for transparent model evaluation (SafeAI, ExplainableAI concepts), full data provenance, and reproducible transformation pipelines. I served as the interface between multinational stakeholders – architects, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, QA, and government programme leads – and delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end, from user stories and acceptance criteria through implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout. One infrastructure feature the project lead had been requesting from the engineering team for over a year I delivered independently in a single week. That is the kind of unblocking I consider part of the role, not exceptional effort.

At the Federal Employment Agency, I was responsible for a public analytics platform (Arbeitsmarktmonitor) covering regional labour market and demographic data. I introduced Dagster for automated ETL pipelines, designed data governance structures, and served concurrently as Deputy IT Security Officer – giving me hands-on experience with confidential data handling and compliance requirements in a regulated environment. Both assignments involved exactly what ZEISS describes: operating as the interface between technical experts and non-technical departments, managing scope, and ensuring delivery momentum without sacrificing quality.

Earlier, at Emil Group, I took over a struggling B2B InsurTech platform mid-delivery. I restructured a bloated 17-person Scrum team into smaller, accountable units, reintroduced velocity tracking and refinement discipline, and rebuilt client trust through structured weekly product workshops. Reducing senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure in a high-pressure environment required the same stakeholder management and organisational clarity your posting emphasises. These are not skills I have adjacent to the PM role – they are the core of how I work.

I bring fluent German and English, direct experience with cloud-deployed AI solutions, and an AI-native working style that means I ship artefacts – requirements documents, prototypes, structured analyses – faster and with fewer coordination cycles than a traditional PM workflow allows. ZEISS's Digital Technology Accelerator mandate – accelerating AI adoption across a precision science company – is exactly the kind of mission where that combination matters.

I would welcome a conversation.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
